

Also in the same month, the first optical data storage disc was developed by Philips; it had 60 times the storage capacity of a 5.25-inch floppy disk. Two years later, in 1982, Philips came out with an erasable optical disc.

Games For Almost All Computers

In 1980, two brothers Doug and Gary Carlston formed a company, Brøderbund to market the games created by Doug. The first hit was scored when Doug wrote Galactic Empire for the TRS-80, a Zilog Z80-based home system. Then the company also started exploring opportunities in the educational and entertainment software markets. Brøderbund soon became one of the most popular publishers - they had released games for almost all major gaming systems. Most games published by Brøderbund at the end of the 1980s grossly focussed on education and productivity areas.

FORTRAN Is Completed

IBM's oldest developed "high-level" language FORTRAN was designed by IBM's group during 1950s (refer chapter 2). American National Standards Institute published a new standard—ANSI X3.9-1978 and the standard definition of FORTRAN was updated. The final draft of FORTRAN 77 was completed in 1977, International Standards Organisation adopted it as International Standard (IS 1539:1980) in 1980. Still, FORTRAN 77 had many missing features—such as a difficulty representing data structures succinctly—which lead to further development of the language known as 'FORTRAN 8x'. FORTRAN was a heavily used programming language for the development of non-commercial programs in the mid-1970s.

A Commercial 16-bit Microcomputer

Mycron released the first commercial 16-bit microcomputer, the Mycron 2000 than ran on the CP/M 86 OS. This computer is used by Digital Research as the development platform for the CP/M-86 operating system. Digital Research was brain child of Dr. Gary Kildall, the creator of CP/M operating system. He found Digital Research for the development of CP/M Operating System and related products.